RISE MARKETING GROUP

For

HEALING JUSTICESB

# Integrated Marketing Communications Plan

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## Rise Google Folder

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1TlVLEqbu728ch0jtMFhw-eqC70TxnwEXmpN4gV6Kfgo/edit?usp=drive_link

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RISE

# Meet Our Team



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# Positioning Statement

Healing Justice Santa Barbara is a Black women–led nonprofit serving African Americans through a healing justice framework. Positioned in the space of community empowerment, it delivers year-round programs in mentorship, cultural arts, education, and collective care. Unlike organizations centered only on advocacy or annual events, HJSB stands out by creating consistent, affirming spaces where Black youth, families, and allies experience safety, joy, and belonging, making it a trusted anchor for resilience and equity.

# Marketing Objectives

By December 2026, launch a BSA Student Ambassador Program that trains Black high school students to represent HJSB, resulting in at least a 25% increase in donor inquiries and 10 new recurring monthly donors.

Increase retention and donor pledges among the older, philanthropic audiences by 25% by Spring of 2026, achieved through exclusive events (Community Impact Social) and personalized communication through the Impact & Opportunities Portal.

# Market Research

## Client Background

Healing Justice Santa Barbara (HJSB) is a Black-led nonprofit serving the Central Coast with a mission to uplift Black/African American residents through healing, safety, dignity, equity, respect, joy, and liberation. Core programs include the Black Student Alliance, cultural/historical preservation, mutual-aid support, and year-round community events, with a long-term goal of establishing a dedicated Black/African American cultural resource center [11]. Recent filings indicate annual revenue of roughly $485,000, which frames current capacity for communications and outreach [2]. For market sizing, Black/African American residents account for about 2% of Santa Barbara County's population—a small, geographically dispersed audience that shapes channel strategy [1].

## Primary Competitors

**Gateway Educational Services** — client-identified as the largest competitor. Local college-access nonprofit serving middle–high school students and families across the South Coast. Programs include 1:1/small-group tutoring, test prep, college advising, and FAFSA/scholarship workshops; they reach families through school partnerships, parent-night events, and newsletter/social channels. Overlaps with HJSB on youth/family attention, education-focused partners, and local funders. HJSB edge: identity-affirming healing/culture spaces, mental-health and community-care supports, and year-round programming beyond academics [15].

**NAACP Santa Barbara & Santa Maria/Lompoc** — regional branches of a national civil-rights organization with policy committees (education, economic opportunity, criminal justice, environment), youth/college councils, scholarships, and recurring community meetings. They activate broad civic and faith networks and a recognizable national brand, which can attract donors and volunteers that overlap with HJSB's base. HJSB edge: hyper-local, trust-based safe-space programming and direct support (e.g., emergency needs) with frequent, hands-on touchpoints for families and youth.

**MLK Jr. Committee of Santa Barbara** — produces a high-visibility annual MLK Weekend (interfaith service, Unity March, keynote speakers, youth recognitions) with media coverage and city-scale partnerships, drawing sponsors and county-wide attention. This concentrates public engagement around Black history and culture during January, overlapping with HJSB's audience and sponsor pools. HJSB edge: sustained, year-round initiatives that convert short-term interest into ongoing programs and services.


[1] U.S. Census Bureau. (n.d.). Santa Barbara County, California – Profile. https://data.census.gov/profile/Santa_Barbara_County,_California?g=050XX00US06083
[2] ProPublica. (n.d.). Healing Justice Santa Barbara – Nonprofit Explorer. https://projects.propublica.org/nonprofits/organizations/881792712
[11] Healing Justice Santa Barbara. (n.d.). About us. https://www.hjsb.org/
[15] Gateway Educational Services. (n.d.). About & Programs. https://gatewayeducationalservices.org/

# Market Research

## Client Communication Challenge

HJSB must grow and diversify funding while reaching a small, geographically dispersed primary audience. Black/African American residents are about 2% of Santa Barbara County, which limits the addressable base and raises the frequency required to move people to action [1]. At the same time, HJSB operates with ~$485,000 in annual revenue and a modest near-term marketing budget, trailing sector norms—many nonprofits allocate ~5–15% of budget and invest $500–$5,000/month on digital [2][3].

**Audience Context**

The core audience is small and spread across the Central Coast, so single-channel pushes rarely achieve effective frequency without sustained, multi-touch communication. Even high-quality content needs more repetitions and smart distribution to convert awareness into participation [1].

**Barriers to Reach**

A persistent county digital divide limits who reliably sees content, and event-cost sensitivity can depress participation even when awareness exists [6]. In addition, authority headwinds documented for Black women leaders can dampen perceived credibility and response rates, especially when audiences rely on quick heuristics to assess messenger trust [4].

**Why This Matters Now**

Relative to benchmarks, HJSB's current communications allocation is closer to ~1%, constraining content throughput, testing cadence, and paid amplification [2][3]. Converging indicators—the small base, thin capacity, authority bias, and local digital inequities—signal underperformance unless strategy shifts [1][4][6].

**Strategic Response**

Prioritize low-cost, high-frequency owned channels—grow email and SMS lists, use simple nurture sequences, and leverage community messaging (e.g., WhatsApp/GroupMe)—and add light A/B tests on subject lines, CTAs, and send times to improve lift without major spend [3]. Borrow reach through partners via structured cross-posting and co-messaging (e.g., NAACP branches, MLK Committee, schools, libraries) during tentpoles and throughout the year to extend distribution beyond HJSB's owned followers.

**90-Day Success Indicators**

Target email list +25% and SMS +15%; email open rate ≥ 35% and click-through ≥ 4%; +15% program sign-ups attributable to owned-channel campaigns; and 3 new recurring donors or 2 micro-grants explicitly tied to communications outcomes—then report these in a monthly, grant-ready one-pager to build the case for incremental budget increases [2][3].


[1] U.S. Census Bureau. (n.d.). *Santa Barbara County, California – Profile.* https://data.census.gov/profile/Santa_Barbara_County,_California?g=050XX00US06083

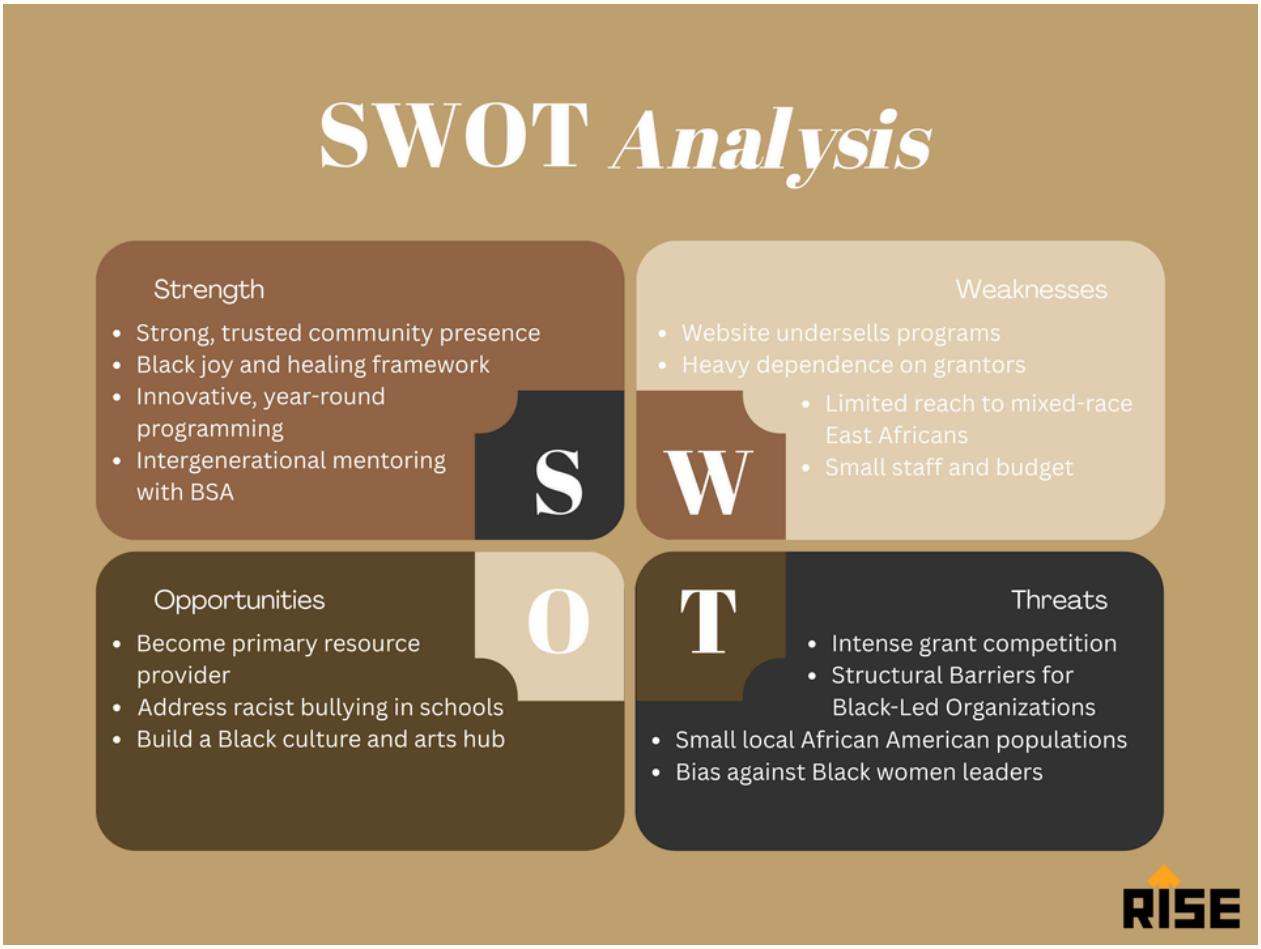
[2] ProPublica. (n.d.). *Healing Justice Santa Barbara – Nonprofit Explorer.* https://projects.propublica.org/nonprofits/organizations/881792712

[3] WebFX. (n.d.). *How to plan a nonprofit marketing budget.* https://www.webfx.com/industries/nonprofits/marketing-budget/

[4] LeanIn & McKinsey. (2021). *Women in the Workplace 2021 – Women of color continue to have a worse experience at work.* https://leanin.org/women-in-the-workplace/2021/women-of-color-continue-to-have-a-worse-experience-at-work

[6] Santa Barbara County Digital Equity Coalition. (n.d.). *Uniting for Digital Equity in Santa Barbara County.* https://sbcdec.org/

# SWOT Analysis



# SWOT Narrative

## Strengths

### Strong, Trusted Community Presence

Healing Justice Santa Barbara, as an organization, is deeply grounded in the lived experience of the Black community. Their consistent efforts since 2020 have bridged institutions and the Black community, fostering trust within the local community. HJSB led one of the largest direct actions in the history of Santa Barbara during the Black Lives Matter movement in 2020, mobilizing thousands into action and advocacy around grief, protest, and collective healing and support. [1] The organization is also often called on by institutions when racial incidents occur, such as their partnership with Riviera Ridge High School, demonstrating their strong network within Santa Barbara and institutional trust. [2]

### Black Joy & Healing Centered Framework

Healing Justice Santa Barbara emphasizes healing as collective care, not simply centered around the individual. Their mission and programming have consistently been centered around uplifting Black people, affirming that they are deserving of care, safety, equity, and joy. This sentiment explicitly calls for remaking self-care as a collective investment in community care, creating a unique space for the organization in Santa Barbara. [3]

[1] Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Our impact. Retrieved from the HJSB website homepage. https://www.hjsb.org/
[2] Healing Justice SB & The Riviera Ridge School. (2023). Healing Justice SB and The Riviera Ridge School hosts Santa Barbara black history exhibition. *Santa Barbara Independent. https://www.independent.com/2023/02/21/healing-justice-sb-and-the-riviera-ridge-school-hosts-santa-barbara-black-history-exhibition/*
[3] Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Mission Statement. Retrieved from the HJSB website homepage. https://www.hjsb.org/

# SWOT Narrative

**Innovative, Year-Round Programming**

HJSB has established itself as a leader in establishing consistent and innovative programming that centers Black expression and storytelling in Santa Barbara. They launched and operated the Black femme-owned art and event venue Melanin Gallery in 2021, which featured exclusively Black artists and allowed them to retain 100% of their sales. They have also offered free therapy for the Black community, have provided the Emergency Needs Fund to address urgent financial barriers for Black individuals and families, and are holding the second annual Black is Beautiful Gala, an event that celebrates Black community and voices. [4]

**Intergenerational Mentoring with BSA**

HJSB has identified its intergenerational mentoring program with the Black Student Alliance as one of its most appreciated programs in the community. They describe it as a dynamic mentorship program that provides a platform for advocacy and visibility for Black high school students, in which Student Mentors play a pivotal role in training the next generation. At the moment, college students work to equip students with essential skills, resources, and guidance, but they hope to expand the program to middle and elementary school students as well, creating lasting positive change in students' lives and empowering them in formative years. [5][6]

[4] Smith, D. (2021). One year later, still seeking healing justice. Santa Barbara Independent. https://www.independent.com/2021/06/15/one-year-later-still-seeking-healing-justice/
[5] Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Black student alliance. Retrieved from the HJSB offerings homepage. https://www.hjsb.org/services
[6] Hamilton, K., Akila Ruskamp, S., & Forney Resch, L. (2024). Client Brief Interview. COMM 166: Marketing Communication.

# SWOT Narrative

## Weaknesses

### Website Undersells Programs

Looking at Healing Justice Santa Barbara's website, we see a clear mission statement that highlights uplifting Black communities and centering those who are overlooked. But beyond that, the site doesn't show the full picture of their impact. A lot of the pages feel vague and empty, like quick blurbs instead of diving into the programs, events, or highlighting real stories of change. It makes the work look much less impactful than it actually is, when in reality, they're building community, creating resources, and pushing for justice. As expressed by the co-founders Simone and Leticia, they feel as though their website needs a 'youthful' makeover. One that showcases the full range of events and opportunities that Healing Justice Santa Barbara offers. [7]

### Heavy Dependence on Grantors

Healing Justice Santa Barbara has a large dependence on grantors in order to keep things running. Due to this dependence on outside sources, the non-profit feels vulnerable to slowdowns or cuts. Co-Founders Leticia and Simone stated that they are always looking for potential grantors to continue building Healing Justice and expanding their community reach. This dedication shows their commitment, but also highlights the challenge of the constant pressure to secure funding and how it can pull them away from developing Healing Justice even further. Without a constant stream of income, they are at risk of falling out of priority for potential grantors. Building a more sustainable income stream will take Healing Justice Santa Barbara far with growth. [8]

[7] Hamilton, K., Akila Ruskamp, S., & Forney Resch, L. (2024). Client Brief Interview. COMM 166: Marketing Communication.
[8] Hamilton, K., Akila Ruskamp, S., & Forney Resch, L. (2024). Client Brief Interview. COMM 166: Marketing Communication.

# SWOT Narrative

**Limited Reach to Mixed-Race East Africans**

Another weakness is Healing Justice Santa Barbara's limited reach to the East African community. The non-profit's mission is to uplift all Black people, but Co-Founders Leticia and Simone still find that there is a sense of disconnect with the group of East Africans in Santa Barbara. By not having engagement with these communities, Healing Justice Santa Barbara is at a weakness by not fully including all possible Black voices. They hope to turn this weakness into a strength by broadening the organization's outreach and impact, with a goal of including mixed-race Black people and East African people into their community. [9]

**Small Staff and Budget**

Healing Justice Santa Barbara works with a small team, with eight members between their collective and board. [10] Running a non-profit with a limited team and budget runs the risk of burnout and loss of opportunity due to not having enough hands to distribute the work with. This, alongside a limited budget, adds another layer of strain to the operation, as it restricts the ability to add more employees to the team. While Healing Justice Santa Barbara shows great determination with the resources they currently have, growing the non-profit will require a constant income stream for a sustainable future.

[9] Hamilton, K., Akila Ruskamp, S., & Forney Resch, L. (2024). Client Brief Interview. COMM 166: Marketing Communication.
[10] Healing Justice Santa Barbara. About us. Retrieved from the HJSB website homepage. https://www.hjsb.org

# SWOT Narrative

## Opportunities

### Becoming a Primary Resource Provider

In Santa Barbara, the already small Black population has only been falling in recent years due to a lack of equitable job and housing opportunities, hitting a low of 1.37% in 2024. Due to the population growing smaller, funding for resources directed toward supporting the Black community has also been cut, leading to the closure of many Black-owned businesses. [11] This presents an opportunity for Healing Justice Santa Barbara to position itself as the primary provider of resources, advocacy, and support for the local Black community. As the existing resources dwindle, HJSB can step in to fill these gaps by strengthening partnerships, attracting new funding streams, and ensuring the preservation of Black culture and community resilience in the region.

### Address Racist Bullying in Schools

Multiple horrific instances of discrimination in Santa Barbara schools have come out, including physical violence and use of slurs, with one instance in 2022 even resulting in two mothers suing the school district for their lack of protective measures. A 2023 report also showed that students were almost never punished for utilizing slurs against African American students and that the district had zero policies in place to protect Black students. [12] This opens an opportunity for Healing Justice Santa Barbara to expand its presence in schools by building and supporting Black Student Unions, giving students a safe space to organize, lead, and advocate for change.

[11]CBM Newswire. (2024). Blacks feel erased by Santa Barbara's changing demographics; — latinos express similar fears. The Observer. https://sacobserver.com/2024/11/blacks-feel-erased-by-santa-barbaras-changing-demographics-latinos-express-similar-fears/

[12] Moore, T. (2024). Black parents tell Santa Barbara school district: years of bullying of black students must stop. The Los Angeles Post. https://lapost.us/?p=68728

# SWOT Narrative

**Create a Hub for Black Culture and Arts**

Due to a lack of resources for Black Americans, many have been forced to move out of the Santa Barbara area, taking their cultural traditions with them. Many who lived in Santa Barbara several decades ago have cited the notable decrease in African-American arts and social gathering places in modern-day Santa Barbara, recounting that several of their cultural hubs now feel gentrified. [13] This presents an opportunity for Healing Justice Santa Barbara to establish itself as a central cultural hub that preserves and uplifts Black arts, music, and traditions. By hosting cultural events, creating community spaces, and supporting Black artists, HJSB can both celebrate heritage and rebuild a sense of belonging for the Black community. Additionally, positioning itself as a cultural anchor would allow Healing Justice Santa Barbara to attract funding, strengthen partnerships, and expand its visibility as a leader in preserving and revitalizing Black culture.

[13] Bastian, J. (2020). Santa Barbara's Eastside was once black community hub. KCRW. https://www.kcrw.com/news/shows/kcrw-features/santa-barbara-black-history

# SWOT Narrative

## Threats

### Intense Competition for Grants

Grant funding for nonprofits in Santa Barbara is extremely competitive, posing a direct threat to Healing Justice Santa Barbara's sustainability. [14] Limited grant pools must be split among many organizations, meaning HJSB competes with numerous groups for the same dollars. [15] For example, the Santa Barbara County Racial Equity Fund received 18 applications requesting $1.1 million, but only $233,000 was available to award in 2025. [16] HJSB was one of eight recipients, securing only $10,000, which is small compared to its broader funding needs. [17] The Fund for Santa Barbara spreads resources thinly, awarding small $5K–$10K grants to non-profits, including HJSB's parenting program. [18] Competing in such a crowded grant space is a constant challenge for HJSB's financial stability.

### Structural Barriers for Black-Led Organizations

Beyond competition, systemic funding barriers continue to disadvantage Black-led groups. A 2025 survey showed that 74% of Black-led nonprofits are underfunded and unable to hire staff. [19] Many grassroots organizations also struggle to meet grant requirements or demonstrate long track records that funders often demand. [20] The relationship gap adds another hurdle, since funders frequently support organizations they already know, leaving newer Black-led groups behind. [21] Additionally, 64% of Black nonprofit leaders reported that a lack of new racial equity funding is a top barrier to advancing their missions. [22] Structural bias and weak funder outreach can prevent HJSB from securing grants, even when their goals match.


[14] Caudillo, M. (2025). Small capacity building grant program guidelines. Santa Barbara Foundation. https://sbfoundation.org/nonprofits/grant-opportunities/scb-grant-guidelines/
[15] Fund for Santa Barbara. (2025). Santa Barbara County Board of Supervisors unanimously approves 2025 racial equity grant In partnership with the fund for Santa Barbara. Santa Barbara Independent. https://www.independent.com/2025/04/02/santa-barbara-county-board-of-supervisors-unanimously-approves-2025-racial-equity-grant-in-partnership-with-the-fund-for-santa-barbara/
[16] Welsh, N. (2025). Santa Barbara supervisors unanimously fund racial equity programs. Santa Barbara Independent. https://www.independent.com/2025/04/01/santa-barbara-supervisors-unanimously-fund-racial-equity-programs/
[17] Fund for Santa Barbara. (2025). Santa Barbara County Board of Supervisors unanimously approves 2025 racial equity grant In partnership with the fund for Santa Barbara. Santa Barbara Independent. https://www.independent.com/2025/04/02/santa-barbara-county-board-of-supervisors-unanimously-approves-2025-racial-equity-grant-in-partnership-with-the-fund-for-santa-barbara/
[18] Reyes, T. (2025). Grant cycle open for local groups addressing social change. Noozhawk. https://www.noozhawk.com/grant-cycle-open-for-local-groups-addressing-social-change/
[19] Reeves, B. (2025). California's economy benefits from black-led nonprofits despite being underfunded. Black Voice News. https://blackvoicenews.com/2025/06/20/california-nonprofits-racial-equity-funding/
[20] City of Santa Barbara. (2024). Community development and human services committee funding recommendations. City of Santa Barbara Human Services and CDBG Programs. https://santabarbaraca.gov/sites/default/files/2024-03/2024-2025%20RECOMMENDATION%20REPORT.pdf
[21] Wade, V. (2020). The funding gap between Black- and white-led organizations is clear—and alarming. Race to Lead. https://racetolead.org/the-funding-gap-between-black-and-white-led-organizations-is-clear-and-alarming/
[22] Reeves, B. (2025). California's economy benefits from black-led nonprofits despite being underfunded. Black Voice News. https://blackvoicenews.com/2025/06/20/california-nonprofits-racial-equity-funding/

# SWOT Narrative

**Small Local African American Populations**

The African American population in Santa Barbara city is extremely small, making up only about 1.4% of the population (roughly 1,238 residents) according to the 2020 Census. [23] This limited population size reduces the base of direct community members HJSB can serve, making outreach and sustained engagement more challenging (City of Santa Barbara Fair Housing Analysis). Historically, the Black population in the city has declined from 3.3% in 1970 to about 1.3–1.4% today, further shrinking visibility and representation. [24] The small population base makes it harder for HJSB to gain visibility and attract local resources.

**Bias Against Black Women Leaders**

Black woman-led nonprofits like HJSB are often overlooked for large-scale funding. [25] Nearly three-quarters of the best-resourced nonprofits are run by white men; women of color often lead under-resourced groups. These tiny budgets limit HJSB's ability to attract funders who often equate scale with legitimacy. [26] In 2020, philanthropic giving to women and girls of color was just $5.48 per capita annually, representing only 0.5% of total foundation giving. Furthermore, the median grant size to organizations led by and for women and girls of color was less than half that of all foundation grants. [27] Despite promises of equity, almost none of foundation funding reaches Black women and girls in proportion to their needs. [28] Locally, HJSB leaders have said they are often not taken seriously by city officials and funders, leaving them without key resources. [29]


[23] U.S. Census Bureau. Santa Barbara County, California. U.S. Census Bureau. U.S. Census Bureau

[24] CBM Newswire. (2024). Blacks feel erased by Santa Barbara's changing demographics; — latinos express similar fears. The Observer. https://sacobserver.com/2024/11/blacks-feel-erased-by-santa-barbaras-changing-demographics-latinos-express-similar-fears/

[25] Ford, L et. al. (2021). Assessing the funding landscape for programs in support of black girls. Urban. https://www.urban.org/sites/default/files/publication/103805/assessing-the-funding-landscape-for-programs-in-support-of-black-girls.pdf

[26] Gamboa, G. (2024). The larger the nonprofit, the more likely it is run by a white man, says new Candid diversity report. AP News. https://apnews.com/article/diversity-study-nonprofits-candid-ann-mei-chang-e5a410b87456bf5b5fbb4e28db37daf6

[27] Thomas, C. (2023). Addressing funding disparities in women of color-led organizations. The University of San Francisco. https://repository.usfca.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=2982&context=capstone

[28] Gamboa, G. (2023). Major funders call for increased support of Black feminists. AP News. https://apnews.com/article/business-philanthropy-7c545feeca154541f61118e4e45a85b2

[29] Calitri, J. (2022). Black history month: talking about the issues with Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Montecito Journal. https://www.montecitojournal.net/2022/03/01/black-history-month-talking-about-the-issues-with-healing-justice-santa-barbara/

# Creative Strategy Statement
# Primary Target Audience Profile




Meet Involved Ivy! Ivy is a 14-year-old East African and mixed-race freshman who just started her first year at San Marcos High School. She is ambitious and eager to get involved with new opportunities, hoping to find a sense of belonging in a school environment that often feels predominantly white. Ivy is passionate about expressing herself through art, music, and literature from the African diaspora, and she stays engaged by volunteering and joining student advocacy groups.(1) Like many teens her age, she spends a lot of time on TikTok and Instagram, where she follows creators who share her interests in creativity and social justice.(2) Ivy's biggest challenge is navigating her mixed-race identity while also trying to excel academically and socially, but she

on a broader spectrum of black and mixed-race ethnicities.

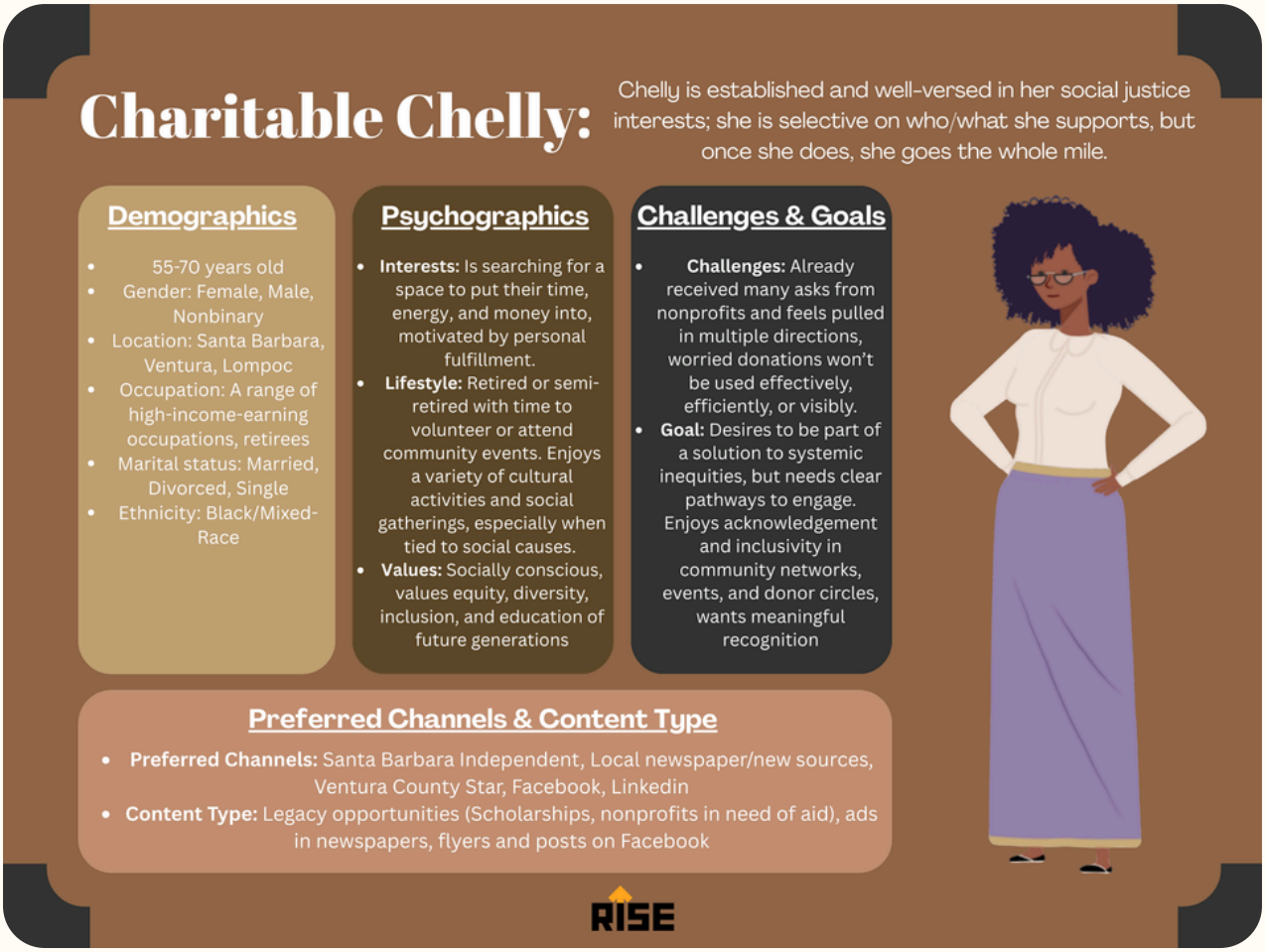
# Creative Strategy Statement
# Primary Target Audience Narrative

remains motivated by her goals of thriving in school, stepping into leadership roles, and finding a supportive community that celebrates her culture. (3)

Although Involved Ivy is a 14-year-old mixed-race East African freshman, her persona is just one possible example of the broader student demographic primary target audience she represents. In a more general view, the primary target audience consists of 14 to 18-year-old students of any gender existing on a broader spectrum of black and mixed-race ethnicities.

(1) Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Our story. Retrieved from the HJSB website About page. HJSB Our Story
(2) Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Our media. Retrieved from the HJSB website Media page. HJSB Media
(3) Pieramici, A. (2024). Healing Justice Santa Barbara turns to historic preservation to ensure a brighter future. Noozhawk. Noozhawk

# Creative Strategy Statement
# Secondary Target Audience Profile




Meet Charitable Chelly! Chelly is a 65-year-old African-American Santa Barbara resident who is transitioning into retirement and seeking purpose through civic engagement.(4) With an annual income of $180,000 and a strong commitment to improving inclusion and equity in her community, Chelly is eager to invest her time, energy, and resources into causes that reflect her values. Currently, she stays connected through community boards, donor events, and philanthropic networks, and is driven by her desire to use her resources for a good cause.(5) Having personally experienced the detrimental effects of systemic racism, she is dedicated to breaking the cycle for the younger generation, specifically Black youth and other marginalized

# Creative Strategy Statement
# Secondary Target Audience Narrative

communities. However, she is currently struggling with choosing an organization to dedicate herself to; she seeks a space where she can see real, measurable change and feel personally connected to their mission.(6) At this pivotal moment in her life, she is searching for an  or an organization that not only aligns with her values but also welcomes her lived experience and leadership as tools to better her community's future.

Although Charitable Chelly is a singular persona, she represents a broader target audience likely consisting of 55-70 year old high-income earning or retired individuals of any gender living along the Central Coast and Santa Barbara County.

(4) Pieramici, A. (2024). Healing Justice Santa Barbara turns to historic preservation to ensure a brighter future. Noozhawk. Noozhawk
(5) Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Our media. Retrieved from the HJSB website Media page. HJSB Media
(6) Healing Justice Santa Barbara. Our story. Retrieved from the HJSB website About page. HJSB Our Story

# Creative Strategy Statement

## Key Consumer Benefit

By participating with HJSB, a consumer gains access to an affirming circle of Black empowerment and cultural celebration, while simultaneously contributing to the collective benefit of all kindred community members. HJSB offers a healing space for the Black community of Santa Barbara to grow, connect, and flourish.

## Promotional Mix

To engage the primary target audience, HJSB will utilize social media channels such as Instagram and TikTok to foster the engagement, collaboration and growth of BSA student ambassadors. Utilizing short-form social media content in tandem with hard posts and larger format productions will foster greater engagement amongst young students and HJSB through peer-to-peer relatability and online interaction. To engage the secondary target audience, HJSB will use a mix of traditional and digital promotional materials designed to emphasize exclusivity and impact. Personalized direct mail invitations with RSVP cards and follow-up email invitations will ensure outreach feels tailored and meaningful. At the event, flyers highlighting the Black Student Alliance and a healing-themed infographic flyer will showcase HJSB's BSA program and impact. A QR code feedback card will be distributed to gather donor impressions in real time, while thank you notes and portal invitations will be used as post-event touchpoints to reinforce connection. Together, these materials create a seamless journey before, during, and after the event, making donors feel valued, engaged, and motivated to support HJSB's mission.

# Creative Strategy Statement

## Visual Elements

The current variety of warm, natural tones is a perfect theme to continue upholding as HJSB continues to create an inclusive, safe, and welcoming space for all Black or mixed-race identities within the local community. Using other naturally adjacent and earthy tones could be a great way to highlight elements or promotions of importance while stimulating excitement, interest, and liveliness to any visual presentation. This earthy palette reflects HJSB's groundedness, resilience, and community roots. Deep brown conveys strength, beige and clay suggest healing and warmth, muted green signals renewal, and bronze-brown embodies empowerment and tradition. When implemented, HJSB can designate predetermined colorways to specific programming for ease of recognition.

#634038 #c0a172 #c38368 #CAC9b4 #916647

## Verbal and Textual Elements

Simple, elegant, strong, lively, fun, and approachable are all qualities that would pair well with HJSB's mission and how it may be ideally presented through textual elements. A serif header font, such as **Abril Fatface**, provides a bold example of these qualities personified. A sans serif subheader font like **Agrandir**, on the other hand, displays characteristics of these same qualities while maintaining a clear and readable disposition throughout promotional material.

**Abril Fatface**

Agrandir

# Primary Tactic I

The proposed tactic is the creation of a social media student ambassador program within Healing Justice Santa Barbara's (HJSB) existing Black Student Association (BSA). Ten students who are already members of the BSA will be selected/volunteer and will be trained as social media ambassadors. These students will attend additional weekly meetings, where they will collaboratively plan and produce short-form video content for TikTok and Instagram. Content will be aligned with current social media trends while also centering the stories, initiatives, and mission of HJSB. By doing so, the organization empowers students with creative control and offers them a sense of belonging, while simultaneously producing authentic, youth-driven content that resonates with peers.

This tactic will reach its intended audience through TikTok and Instagram, two platforms widely used by people of all ages and backgrounds. In fact, research shows that over ⅓ of all U.S. adults have TikTok downloaded and half of all adults on the app consult TikTok for news updates as opposed to other, more traditional platforms.(1) TikTok has also proven its effectiveness in promoting grassroots movements. Social media is the new wave for activism, as it allows ordinary people to raise their voices and influence the ideas of the world on a global scale from their bedroom due to the power of the algorithm.(2) In fact, TikTok has been proven to be one of the most effective algorithms to reach virality for anybody. Due to its For You page feature, even if a person has no followers at all, all content appears on someone's FYP, which will make it easier for HJSB's new page to get off the ground more quickly and reach more people than other platforms.(3) The program is expected to increase student engagement with HJSB, while externally projecting the organization's mission to a broader community audience, including potential donors.

Importantly, this approach leverages low cost, peer-led content production, reducing expenses while generating culturally relevant, trend accurate content that HJSB has struggled to consistently create. The end-state scenario introduces three factors not currently present:
1) a structured and continuous stream of youth-created digital content.
2) ongoing student involvement and leadership within the already present BSA.
3) stronger donor visibility into HJSB's active programming through relatable, trend-driven media.

The donor impact of this tactic is twofold. First, the visibility created by consistent short-form content will showcase HJSB's mission and impact in ways that resonate with broader audiences, enhancing organizational credibility and inspiring donor trust. Social media analytics (such as follower growth, engagement rates, and content shares) serve as visible proof points of momentum that appeal to donors looking for evidence of community support and relevance.

# Primary Tactic I

Second, HJSB will directly connect donors to the student ambassador program by hosting annual donor workshops. In these workshops, donors with business, marketing, or communications expertise will be invited to share skills such as social media strategy, videography, or trend analysis with student ambassadors. This not only provides donors with hands-on purpose within the organization, but also gives students professional development, mentorship, and networking opportunities. Donors become co-creators of impact, reinforcing their long-term commitment while cultivating pride in their contributions.

As for the budget, we estimate that HJSB should allocate approximately $1,000 for the first year. As we are aware that HJSB is looking to draw in more funding, we are trying to be as cost effective as possible. We plan that students should be able to utilize their own pre-existing cell phones for content, or share between them if a student does not possess a smartphone. As for supplies, we estimate that a ring-light and tripod (these items will help the smart phone shot content look more professional and high quality) will be around $30 per student. So, with 10 students, this should add up to approximately $300.(4)(5) Additionally, we hope to provide the students some form of stipend/incentive to participate in the program. While this is a volunteer position, studies show that over 80% of people report feeling more engaged and meaningful in their work when they are provided with fair compensation.(6) Thus, we advise delegating a $50 gift card to each student as a “thank you” and incentive, so multiplied by 10 students is $500 in all. For similar reasons, we also believe that we should set aside money to compensate donor workshop speakers to ensure their engagement in their lectures. We propose about $100 per speaker per workshop, so for 2 workshops a year would be $200 annually.

Our KPIs will be measured through 4 distinct areas: donor impact, digital metrics, youth engagement, and donor participation. The first, and most important, performance indicator is donor impact. As our main goal for this marketing campaign is to draw in more funding, it is extremely important that HJSB sees a high return on investment for the time, money, and effort put into this new initiative. We predict that HJSB will see a minimum increase of 25% in donor form completions and an additional 10 monthly donors by the end of 2026. Digital metrics will also be key to measuring this program's success. Instagram and TikTok both feature easy to use analytics platforms open for free to all users to track engagement. By our current timeline of December 2026, we hope to triple HJSB’s current engagement on Instagram reels and (since their TikTok is not yet open and will start at zero) create an average of at least 1,000 views on all videos on HJSB’s TikTok account.

# Primary Tactic I

Additionally, youth engagement will be key to ensuring that this program is long-lasting. As this program is reliant on students, it is imperative that students will continue with the program and not quit. To track student engagement, we will track meeting attendance to ensure we are not losing ambassadors and number of videos ambassadors post per week. We are hoping for minimum 2 videos a week per student to stay consistent in the algorithm. Lastly, we will measure donor participation outside of monetary donations. As we hope this program will also allow donors to provide more hands-on opportunities to teach workshops, we will track donor participation interest. We hope to host a minimum of 2 workshops per year.

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# Primary Tactic II

For our second primary tactic, we wanted to build upon the aforementioned Youth Ambassador Program to further student development through a Donor-Student Mentorship Program we call the "Healing Justice Mentorship Network."

For students, this program offers invaluable networking opportunities and career understanding in a time of high uncertainty in education and the job market. (1) (2) By connecting with local leaders in education, business, advocacy, and the arts, students gain access to role models and mentors who can help them navigate professional pathways. Research shows that strengthening graduate networks is essential to reducing racial disparities in employment, as Black job seekers are less likely than their white peers to have connections within target companies or to see their networks mobilize resources on their behalf. (3) This gap presents HJSB with a unique opportunity to expand Black youth networks in Santa Barbara. Along with access to networks and useful connections, students will be able to develop crucial career-specific skills– resume building, interview prep, leadership coaching. Beyond surface-level career readiness, students will be able to be mentored by an individual with whom they can identify with and relate to. This relatability is important in building confidence in students, as "when youth in… mentoring relationships share the same racial and/or ethnic identity with their mentor, they tend to report more positive racial-ethnic identity." (4)

For donors, the benefit is mutual– they will have the opportunity to share their wisdom and life experiences with the next generation, the opportunity to have a direct impact on ambitious young leaders in Santa Barbara. Beyond financial contributions, donors can actively invest in the personal and professional growth of students, fostering relationships that extend well beyond a single program cycle. This sense of emotional investment and legacy-building deepens donor connection to HJSB's mission, making their involvement more meaningful and rewarding. In turn, these authentic relationships are a powerful driver of donor retention, helping sustain and even increase contributions as donors see the tangible results of their mentorship reflected in student success stories. (5)

The mentorship program offers several ways for students and donors to engage meaningfully. It begins with informal one-on-one coffee chats at local cafés, providing a relaxed environment for students and mentors to connect. Matches are thoughtfully designed using a personalized system that takes into account career goals, personality traits, and individual preferences, ensuring productive and lasting relationships. These connections are further strengthened through collaborative community service projects, such as a historical preservation initiative where students and mentors document, archive, and share the histories of Santa Barbara's Black community,

# Primary Tactic II
# Healing Justice Mentorship Network

focusing on neighborhoods and landmarks that have faced erasure. Additional program offerings include shadowing days, during which students spend a half-day with mentors at their workplaces to gain real-world exposure and networking opportunities, and skill-building workshops, where mentors guide students through resume development, mock interviews, and LinkedIn profile optimization, equipping them with practical tools for college and career readiness.

We estimate the total budget for the program to be approximately $2,500. Coffee Chats are projected to cost $300–$400, covering light refreshments and food at local Santa Barbara cafés. [6] Skill-building workshops are budgeted at $600, providing basic workshop materials (folders, notepads, pens, name badges), [7] access to printing for résumés and mock applications, and rental of accessible meeting spaces if free venues are unavailable. In addition, a portion of funds can be used for guest speaker honoraria, acknowledging the value of local professionals donating their time to lead sessions on résumé building, LinkedIn profiles, and interview preparation. Student stipends are set at $150 per student. These stipends ensure equitable access by offsetting transportation costs (bus passes, gas cards, or rideshare credits), meal support during longer workshops, and incidental costs of participation (e.g. professional clothing for interviews or networking events). The program is designed to be scalable, allowing HJSB to expand or adapt its scope over time based on budget constraints and organizational capacity.

To measure program success, HJSB will track outcomes in both student development and donor engagement. For students, pre- and post-program surveys will assess confidence with a goal of achieving a 20% improvement. Additionally, more than 80% of mentees are expected to secure significant roles within one year of participation. For donors, success will be reflected in retention and involvement, with a target of at least 75% of donors continuing to mentor or fund the program into Year 2, and 60% of invited donors attending at least one program offering.

Outreach for this program can include a flyer advertising the network and its strengths, eventually expanding to real success stories that can be showcased on the website and social media, along with an application for mentees, while donors will be recruited through events and emails. (Appendix A)

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[7] Link to Staples Print & Marketing Services https://www.staples.com/services/printing/

# Primary Tactic II Promotional Materials

## Healing Justice Mentorship Network

Interested in furthering your career or improving your college application? Look no further than HJSB's Mentorship Network!



– Network with leaders in education, business & advocacy
– Gain career insights & hands-on guidance
– Mentorship from relatable role models
– Coffee chats, shadowing days, skill workshops, and more!

Get involved:

Email - info@hjsb.org; sruskamp@hjsn.org
Phone # 1- 805) 467-1911
Instagram: @healingjusticesb

**Apply to be a mentee today!**

To apply: tinyurl@HJSBMentorNetwork.com

## Healing Justice Mentorship Network

Apply to be a mentee today!



Interested in furthering your career or improving your college application? Look no further than HJSB's Mentorship Network!

# Secondary Tactic I
# The Community Impact Social

Healing Justice Santa Barbara can host quarterly donor socials at Alice Keck Park Memorial Gardens, a scenic and centrally located Santa Barbara park that is often used for public and nonprofit gatherings. Santa Barbara has a large retired population, with more than 20% of residents over 65 years old, many of whom are active in philanthropy and volunteering. This makes them an ideal target audience for cultivation. The program at the event will be structured to highlight HJSB's direct community impact: attendees will receive a flyer about the Black Student Alliance (BSA) (Appendix B), students will share their personal success stories, and trainee students will speak about the value of advocacy training. Additionally, youth participants will describe how leadership skills are essential for their growth and how HJSB is helping them uplift their communities. This structure not only demonstrates tangible outcomes but also allows potential donors to hear directly from beneficiaries, a proven method for increasing empathy and donor motivation. Storytelling is one of the strongest tools in nonprofit fundraising because it builds emotional connections that significantly increase donations. Research shows that people remember stories 22 times more than facts alone, and 70% of donors are more likely to give to a nonprofit that shares impactful stories about its work.(8)

The Community Impact Social will be carefully structured to make donors feel both valued and included as essential partners in HJSB's mission. The evening will begin with a warm welcome and a brief introduction to HJSB's values of equity, healing, and leadership, setting the tone that this gathering is not just a fundraiser but a community of shared purpose. Attendees will be personally greeted by student leaders and staff, reinforcing a sense of intimacy and recognition. The program will highlight storytelling through student success narratives, advocacy training testimonials, and youth leadership reflections, giving donors direct access to the voices of those impacted. For this, we'll need student advocates, leaders, and trainee students from both high school and middle school to be present. In return, they will gain opportunities to strengthen their communication, public speaking, and networking skills.

To create a sense of exclusivity, the evening will feature a private "Donor Circle Session" where a small group of attendees will be invited into a guided conversation with youth leaders and staff. In this space, donors will not only hear powerful firsthand stories but also be given the opportunity to ask questions, share ideas, and see how their future support can shape programs in real time. During the Donor Circle Session, the host will also introduce the opportunity to enroll in the HJSB Mentorship Network program, where students can connect with donors for guidance. This can take the form of one-on-one mentorship or small group sessions, depending on each donor's interest. The mentorship program will allow donors to stay socially active, share their experiences, and play a direct role in shaping future leaders, while also becoming part of HJSB's greater mission of

# Secondary Tactic I
# The Community Impact Social

empowering the youth. For students, it provides the chance to receive advice from experienced professionals, gain valuable networking opportunities, and learn from people with years of real-world experience. Following this, an interactive feedback moment will be incorporated, where donors can share their reflections, offer suggestions, and voice the areas of impact they care most about. This ensures that donors are not just listeners but active participants in shaping HJSB's vision and strategies, reinforcing their role as co-creators of change. To further support engagement, each attendee will receive a promotional package that includes a Black Student Alliance informational flyer, a QR code survey card, a personalized thank-you note, along with an invitation to join the exclusive Impact & Opportunities Portal on HJSB's website (see Appendix B).

The event will conclude with closing remarks that acknowledge each attendee's presence as a vital contribution, affirming their involvement in an exclusive circle of supporters directly shaping the future of Black youth leadership in Santa Barbara. To ensure the experience is meaningful and continuously improving, a brief post-event survey will also be circulated via QR code cards and follow-up email, inviting donors to share their overall impressions, reflections, and suggestions. This final step not only gathers valuable feedback but also reinforces that their voices matter in shaping HJSB's future engagement. This intentional mix of personal interaction, private access, visible recognition, and active feedback ensures donors leave with a sense of belonging, pride, and motivation to sustain their support.

To attract wealthy retirees who are active in civic life, invitations will be sent through a multi-channel approach. First, HJSB should leverage mailing lists from the Santa Barbara Foundation, which manages one of the largest philanthropic donor networks in the county.(9) Next, the Santa Barbara Rotary Club, known for its membership of retired professionals, provides a direct line to affluent community members already engaged in service and philanthropy.(10) Additional outreach will target neighborhood associations in Montecito, with a median household income estimated at approximately $222,966 in 2023, significantly higher than the state and national averages, and a high proportion of residents are retirees, making it one of the county's wealthiest enclaves. (11)(12) HJSB can contact several key foundations in Santa Barbara for donor information and support: the Santa Barbara Foundation, the Women's Fund of Santa Barbara, the Scholarship Foundation of Santa Barbara, the Fund for Santa Barbara, and the Santa Barbara Bowl Foundation's donors' list. Additionally, larger private foundations in the area include the Towbes Foundation, Wood-Claeyssens Foundation, Hugh E & Marjorie Spetersen Foundation, Hutton Parker Foundation, La Centra-Sumerlin Foundation, James S Bower Foundation, and Swift Foundation, which can be found via resources like Instrumentl and Cause IQ directories.(13)(14) HJSB can reach out to these f

# Secondary Tactic I
# The Community Impact Social

boundations to access potential donor details, network, and gain research support within the community philanthropic ecosystem. Invitations can be delivered by direct mail (letters with RSVP cards) and personalized email invitations, as research shows that direct mail still outperforms email in response rates, ranging from 2.7% to 15.3%, compared to email's average of 0.6%, especially when combined with personalization and donor segmentation strategies. Messaging should emphasize exclusivity ("an intimate evening in the park with student leaders") and direct impact ("see firsthand how your support strengthens Black youth leadership"), as exclusive donor events are proven to increase the perceived value of participation and boost giving likelihood. According to a 2024 guide from BetterWorld, providing exclusive experiences such as private dinners, special tours, or intimate receptions makes donors feel uniquely valued and appreciated, which strengthens their emotional connection to the cause and increases their propensity to give.(15)

The estimated budget is affordable at under $3,000: city park permit for Alice Keck is approximately $153/day,(16) refreshments from Anna's Bakery roughly $1.75 per cookies(17) with coffee service from Handlebar Coffee at roughly $150 for 30–50 people,(18) printed flyers/invitations run about $0.42/unit or ~$41.99 for 100 copies,(19) and for rentals and decors an estimated cost of $2.87 per chair, renting 40 chairs would amount to approximately $115.(20) With contingency funds, the event would total around $1,000.

KPIs include tracking attendance (goal: 30–50 donors), number of new pledges secured (≥10 per event), post-event surveys of donor connection, and total funds raised ($5,000–$10,000 cumulative per quarter).


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(20 )Just 4 Fun Party Rentals in Santa Barbara. Rental Chairs. https://just4funpartyrentals.com/rental-category/rent-tables-and-chairs/chairs/

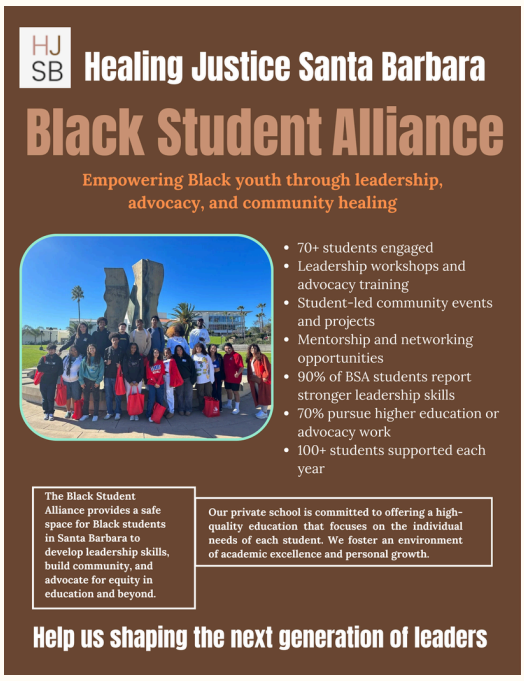
# Secondary Tactic I Promotional Materials



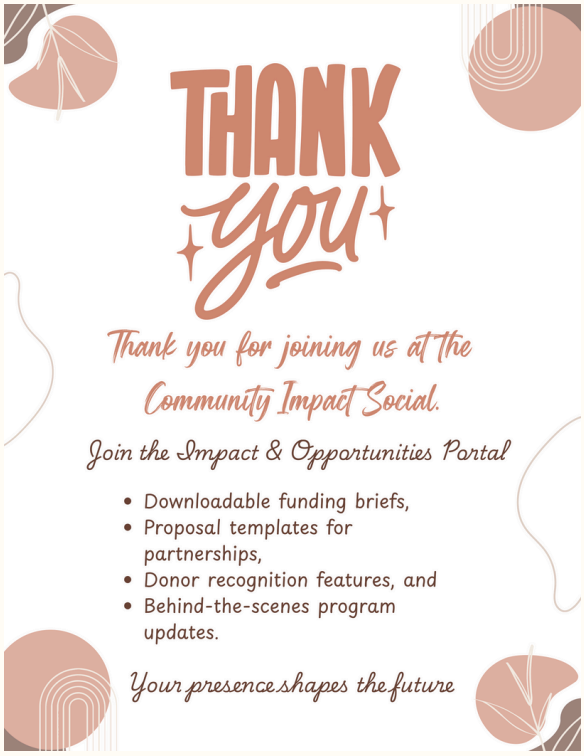






# Secondary Tactic 1
## Promotional Materials Continued









# Secondary Tactic II
## Impact & Opportunities Portal

Healing Justice Santa Barbara (HJSB) should redesign their website to include a centralized "Impact & Opportunities" portal that integrates both public storytelling and exclusive donor access features. Publicly, this portal would showcase video testimonials from Black Student Alliance (BSA) members, stories of student leadership, and multimedia content highlighting advocacy training and skill-building programs. Research shows that storytelling increases donor motivation because people remember stories 22 times more than facts alone,(21) and 68% of donors say they are more likely to give after seeing real-life impact stories.(22) Beyond stories, the portal should feature interactive charts of distributed funds, infographics on program outcomes, and annual reports that quantify HJSB's community impact. These features present HJSB as a transparent, data-driven nonprofit, building donor trust and making the funding decision process easier. Importantly, the site would be SEO-optimized so that funders searching for "Black-led nonprofits in Santa Barbara" or "youth leadership programs" can discover HJSB more easily.(23)

In addition to the public-facing resources, the portal should include a password-protected donor section, creating an exclusive "community of funders." Here, major donors and partners could log in to view special resources not available elsewhere: downloadable funding briefs, proposal templates for partnerships, donor recognition features, and behind-the-scenes program updates.

In addition to the public-facing resources, the portal should include a password-protected donor section, creating an exclusive "community of funders." Here, major donors and partners could log in to view special resources not available elsewhere: downloadable funding briefs, proposal templates for partnerships, donor recognition features, and behind-the-scenes program updates. This exclusivity not only recognizes donors but also fosters a sense of belonging and establishes credibility. It is important, since recognition and personalized experiences are proven to increase donor loyalty.(24) The private donor portal could also include a "legacy giving section", explaining how to add HJSB to wills or trusts and showing how long-term gifts sustain Black youth leadership. Research finds that the average donor in the United States is 64 years old and makes two charitable gifts a year,(25) making this especially relevant to HJSB's older secondary audience in Santa Barbara and Montecito. By combining impact transparency (charts, reports, BSA videos) with exclusive donor features, HJSB both attracts new donors and deepens relationships with existing ones. Website design and user experience (UX) for a nonprofit impact portal is commonly estimated at around $75-$125 per hour, with a typical project requiring 10-15 hours of work, translating to about $1,200 in total. This estimate aligns with industry averages for nonprofit website design services, which range from $500 to $2,000 for smaller, focused website sections or portals, depending on complexity and designer expertise.(26) Nonprofit impact page design projects often cost between $1,000 and

# Secondary Tactic II
# Impact & Opportunities Portal

$1,500, reflecting required design, wireframing, and UX optimization time.(27) Content creation, including video editing, testimonials, and infographics, can cost approximately $900, reflecting typical freelance videographer rates of $45-$75 per hour for a 12-15 hour project. (28) Because HJSB already has access to an affordable photographer and video editor, this can be more affordable.

Web development and integration of a secure donor-only section with password protection is reasonably estimated at around $1,000, based on mid-level developer rates averaging $60-$100 per hour and a 10-15 hour development timeline. According to nonprofit website cost guides, custom website features such as gated content, login portals, and secure file downloads typically require 10-15 hours to develop at rates within this range, especially if using WordPress or similar CMS platforms. (29)(30)  This aligns with industry-standard freelance developer pricing and the complexity involved in building secure donor access areas for nonprofits. SEO optimization plus analytics setup can be budgeted at $400 for 4-6 hours of specialist work.(31) This breakdown totals $3,500, delivering a polished, functional, and donor-engaging portal without exceeding budget constraints.

Measurement (KPI) Success will be measured by monthly portal visits, downloads of impact reports, and new donor registrations for the password-protected area. Web analytics and CRM integration (e.g., Google Analytics with donation tracking) will allow HJSB to directly attribute donations to portal engagement. KPIs include a 25% increase in online donations within six months, at least 15 new legacy gift inquiries in the first year, and a measurable uptick in donor retention rates among portal users compared to non-users. Additional success indicators include increased average donation size, industry benchmarks show donors give more when they see transparent reporting and recognition features,(32) and higher repeat visitation to donor pages. By creating a dynamic, data-driven, and donor-centered portal, HJSB will position itself as both an accountable and inspiring nonprofit, driving trust, credibility, and ultimately, more sustained funding.


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